Terms of Reference (ToR)

School Supply Distribution Programme

Field	Details
Project Reference	ADA/2022/001
Project Title	School Supply Distribution
Implementing Organization	Apoti Development Association (ADA)
Location	Buea, South-West Region, Cameroon
Duration	February 1–28, 2022 (1 month)
Total Budget	$500 USD (≈300,000 CFA)
Date Issued	January 15, 2022

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1. Background & Context

Orphaned children in Cameroon's South-West Region face compounding disadvantages that severely limit their access to education and basic necessities. The loss of one or both parents — whether through the ongoing Anglophone crisis, disease, or other causes — often leaves children in the care of elderly relatives, overburdened extended family members, or community institutions with limited resources. These children frequently attend school without basic supplies, eating utensils, or adequate materials for daily life, creating barriers to both learning and dignity.

In rural communities surrounding Buea, primary schools serve as critical anchors for vulnerable children, providing not only education but also structure, socialization, and — in some cases — the only consistent adult supervision a child receives. However, many orphaned children attend school without bags to carry their materials, without plates or cups for school feeding programmes, and without the basic household items that other children take for granted. The absence of these items marks them as different, contributing to social stigma and reduced self-esteem.

The Anglophone crisis, now in its sixth year, has devastated the education system in the South-West Region. Schools have been targets of violence, teachers have fled, and enrollment has dropped dramatically. Those schools that remain open — particularly in rural areas — operate with minimal resources and cannot provide supplies to students. Parents and guardians who might have purchased school materials face economic hardship from displacement, loss of livelihoods, and market disruption.

The Apoti Development Association (ADA), having completed its inaugural widow home visits in November 2021 (ADA/2021/001), identified the needs of orphaned children as a natural extension of its mission. Several of the widows visited in 2021 were caring for grandchildren who lacked basic school supplies. This project represents ADA's first school-based intervention and its first event targeting children — a significant expansion from individual home visits to a community-level distribution event. The growth of the volunteer team from 3 to 8 members reflects increasing community confidence in ADA's mission and capacity.

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2. Project Objectives

General Objective

To improve the material well-being and educational readiness of orphaned children attending a rural primary school in Buea, South-West Region, Cameroon, through the provision of essential school supplies and household items.

Specific Objectives

1. **SO1:** To procure and distribute complete supply kits (school bags, plastic buckets, plates, cups, and utensils) to 20 identified orphaned children at a rural primary school by February 15, 2022.
2. **SO2:** To conduct an interactive engagement session with beneficiary children to foster a sense of community, belonging, and encouragement.
3. **SO3:** To establish ADA's first institutional partnership with a primary school as a platform for future child-focused programming.
4. **SO4:** To demonstrate ADA's expanded operational capacity through the coordination of 8 volunteers in a school-based distribution event.
5. **SO5:** To document the event and beneficiary profiles as a foundation for future child welfare programming and donor reporting.

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3. Target Beneficiaries

Primary Beneficiaries

Criterion	Detail
Number	20 orphaned children
Gender	Male and female
Age	5–12 years (primary school age)
Location	Rural primary school, Buea municipality
Status	Orphaned (one or both parents deceased); enrolled in primary school

Selection Criteria

Beneficiaries shall be identified in collaboration with school administration and must meet the following criteria:

- Enrolled at the partner primary school
- Orphaned (one or both parents deceased)
- Living with extended family, grandparents, or community caregivers
- Lacking basic school supplies (bag, writing materials)
- Lacking basic household items (eating utensils, storage containers)
- Identified by school teachers or administration as being in material need

Indirect Beneficiaries

- Caregivers and guardians of the orphaned children (reduced financial burden for school supplies)
- School community (improved morale, demonstration of community support)
- ADA volunteer team (capacity building, team cohesion, organizational learning)

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4. Scope of Work / Activities

The project shall undertake the following activities:

4.1 School Partnership & Beneficiary Identification

- Engage school administration to establish partnership and obtain permission for distribution event
- Collaborate with teachers to identify eligible orphaned children using selection criteria
- Verify beneficiary list through school records and community consultation
- Finalize list of 20 beneficiary children with basic profile information

4.2 Procurement of Supply Kits

- Purchase 20 colorful plastic buckets (to serve as storage containers and carrying vessels)
- Purchase 20 sets of plates, cups, and eating utensils
- Purchase 20 pink school bags suitable for primary school children
- Inspect all items for quality and completeness
- Assemble individual kits: bucket filled with plate, cup, and utensils, paired with school bag

4.3 Event Logistics & Preparation

- Coordinate event date and venue with school administration
- Organize volunteer team roles and responsibilities (8 volunteers)
- Arrange vehicle hire for transporting supply kits to school
- Prepare event programme including interactive engagement activities
- Print beneficiary acknowledgment forms and event documentation materials

4.4 Distribution Event

- Transport all supply kits to the school on event day (February 15, 2022)
- Set up distribution area within school premises
- Conduct interactive engagement session with children (songs, encouragement, group activities)
- Distribute individual supply kits to each identified beneficiary child
- Ensure each child receives complete kit and understands the contents
- Provide refreshments to children during the event

4.5 Documentation & Photography

- Photograph the distribution event (with school and guardian consent)
- Record beneficiary acknowledgment of items received
- Document volunteer participation and team coordination
- Capture children's reactions and engagement for organizational records

4.6 Post-Event Reporting

- Compile event report with photos, beneficiary data, and outcomes
- Document lessons learned and recommendations for future school-based events
- Prepare financial accountability report with receipts
- Share summary with school administration and ADA board

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5. Expected Outcomes & Indicators

Expected Outcome	Indicator	Means of Verification

20 orphaned children receive complete supply kits	Number of kits distributed	Distribution records, beneficiary acknowledgment forms
Children engage in interactive community-building session	Number of children participating in engagement activities	Event photos, volunteer reports
School partnership established	Written or verbal agreement with school administration	Correspondence records, meeting notes
ADA demonstrates expanded volunteer capacity	Number of volunteers coordinated for event	Volunteer attendance records, event photos
Event documented for future programming	Completion of event report with photos and data	Final report document, photo archive
Children express increased sense of belonging	Qualitative observations during event	Volunteer observation notes, event report

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6. Timeline & Milestones

Week	Dates	Activities	Milestone
Week 1	Feb 1–5, 2022	School engagement; partnership agreement; beneficiary identification and verification with teachers	Beneficiary list finalized (20 children)
Week 2	Feb 6–10, 2022	Market procurement of buckets, utensils, school bags; quality inspection; kit assembly	All 20 supply kits assembled and ready
Week 3	Feb 11–15, 2022	Final logistics coordination; volunteer briefing; vehicle hire; event execution on February 15	Distribution event completed
Week 4	Feb 16–28, 2022	Post-event documentation; photo compilation; financial reconciliation; report writing	Final report and financial report submitted

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7. Budget Summary

Line Item	Description	Unit Cost (CFA)	Qty	Total (CFA)	Total (USD)
Plastic buckets	Colorful plastic buckets for storage/carrying	3,000	20	60,000	$100.00
Plates, cups & utensils	Complete eating set per child	5,000	20	100,000	$166.67
School bags	Pink school bags for primary school children	4,000	20	80,000	$133.33

Transport	Vehicle hire for kit delivery to school	—	1	25,000	$41.67
Refreshments	Drinks and snacks for children during event	—	—	15,000	$25.00
Communication	Airtime for coordination with school, volunteers	—	—	5,000	$8.33
Documentation & printing	Beneficiary forms, event materials, printing	—	—	5,000	$8.33
Contingency	Unforeseen expenses (≈3.3%)	—	—	10,000	$16.67
TOTAL				**300,000**	**$500.00**

Exchange rate applied: 1 USD = 600 CFA (approximate, February 2022)

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8. Implementation Approach

Methodology

The project employs a **school-based, community-partnership, event-driven** approach:

1. **Institutional Partnership:** Unlike ADA's previous door-to-door model, this project partners with an existing institution (primary school) to identify beneficiaries and host the distribution event. This approach enables reaching more beneficiaries efficiently while building sustainable relationships with community institutions.

2. **Kit-Based Distribution:** Rather than distributing individual items, the project provides complete kits (bucket + utensils + school bag) that address multiple needs simultaneously. The bucket serves as both a carrying vessel and a storage container, maximizing utility.

3. **Interactive Engagement:** The distribution is embedded within an engagement session designed to make children feel valued and celebrated, not merely recipients of charity. Songs, encouragement, and group activities create a positive, memorable experience.

4. **Volunteer-Driven:** The expanded team of 8 volunteers enables a more ambitious event while maintaining ADA's low-overhead, community-based model. Volunteer roles are clearly defined to ensure smooth coordination.

5. **Dignity-Centred:** All children receive identical kits to avoid comparison or stigma. The event is designed to be celebratory rather than transactional, emphasizing community care over charitable handout.

Team Composition

Role	Number	Responsibilities
Project Coordinator	1	Overall coordination, school liaison, reporting
Logistics Lead	1	Procurement, transport, kit assembly

Event Facilitator	1	Interactive session planning and facilitation
Documentation Lead	1	Photography, beneficiary forms, event records
Distribution Volunteers	4	Kit distribution, child engagement, crowd management

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9. Monitoring & Evaluation

Monitoring Framework

Level	Activity	Frequency	Responsible
Input	Budget tracking, procurement verification, kit quality check	Weekly / pre-event	Logistics Lead
Process	Volunteer coordination, event preparation tracking	Daily during event week	Project Coordinator
Output	Distribution count, beneficiary acknowledgment forms	During event	Documentation Lead
Outcome	Child engagement observations, school feedback	During and after event	Event Facilitator

Evaluation Approach

- **Pre-event checklist:** Verification that all 20 kits are complete and transport is confirmed
- **Event-day monitoring:** Real-time tracking of distribution progress and child engagement
- **Post-event debrief:** Team meeting within 48 hours to capture observations, challenges, and lessons
- **School feedback:** Brief conversation with school administration regarding event execution and impact
- **Beneficiary observation:** Qualitative notes on children's reactions and engagement during the event

Success Criteria

The project will be considered successful if:

- All 20 identified children receive complete supply kits
- The interactive engagement session is conducted with active child participation
- The event is completed within the planned timeline and budget
- School administration expresses willingness for future collaboration
- A comprehensive event report with photos is produced within 2 weeks of the event
- At least 3 actionable recommendations for future school-based events are identified

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10. Reporting Requirements

Report	Content	Due Date	Recipient
Beneficiary List	Names, ages, class levels of 20 identified children	February 5, 2022	Project files, school administration

Event Report	Full narrative including: preparation, event description, outcomes, photos, observations, lessons learned	February 28, 2022	ADA Board, project files
Financial Report	Itemized expenditure against budget, receipts, variance analysis	February 28, 2022	ADA Executive Director, ADA Board
Photo Documentation	Organized photo archive of event with captions	February 28, 2022	ADA communications, project files
School Feedback Summary	Brief record of school administration's feedback on the event	February 22, 2022	Project files

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11. Implementing Organization

Field	Details
Name	Apoti Development Association (ADA)
Type	Faith-based non-governmental organization
Year Founded	2021
Registration	Registered in Cameroon
Mission	Empowering vulnerable communities through faith-based programmes supporting widows, orphans, and young women
Headquarters	Buea, South-West Region, Cameroon
Email	info@apotidev.org
Phone	+237 676 282 346 (WhatsApp)
Website	https://apotidev.org

Organizational Mandate

ADA was established in 2021 to address the needs of the most vulnerable populations in Cameroon's South-West Region, with a particular focus on widows, orphans, and young women at risk. Following the successful completion of its inaugural project (ADA/2021/001 — First Widow Home Visits), ADA is expanding its programming to include child-focused interventions, beginning with this school supply distribution.

This project — ADA/2022/001 — represents a significant organizational milestone: ADA's first school-based event, first child-focused intervention, and first project with an expanded volunteer team of 8 members (up from 3 in the inaugural project).

Previous Project Experience

Reference	Title	Date	Beneficiaries	Budget	Status
ADA/2021/001	First Widow Home Visits	November 2021	3 elderly widows	$200 USD	Completed

12. Risks & Assumptions

Assumptions

- School administration will cooperate in identifying eligible orphaned children and hosting the event
- Identified children will be present at school on the distribution day
- Market prices for buckets, utensils, and school bags will remain within budgeted estimates
- All 8 volunteers will be available on the event day
- Road and transport conditions will permit vehicle access to the school
- Weather conditions will allow an outdoor or semi-outdoor event
- Guardians/caregivers will consent to their children's participation and photography

Risks & Mitigation

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Security deterioration due to Anglophone crisis restricts movement or school closure	Medium	High	Monitor security situation; identify backup date; maintain communication with school on operational status
Fewer than 20 eligible children identified at the school	Low	Medium	Expand identification to neighbouring schools or community referrals; adjust kit quantities accordingly
Market price increases exceed budget for supply items	Low	Medium	Procure early in project cycle; seek wholesale pricing; adjust item specifications within budget
Volunteer attrition on event day	Low	Medium	Confirm attendance 48 hours before; identify 2 standby volunteers; assign backup roles
Adverse weather on distribution day	Medium	Low	Identify indoor backup venue at school; have flexible date option
Children absent on distribution day	Low	Low	Coordinate with school to ensure attendance; hold reserved kits for absent children to collect later
Transport vehicle unavailable on event day	Low	Medium	Confirm booking 72 hours before; identify alternative vehicle; consider splitting transport across two trips

13. Approval

This Terms of Reference is hereby approved for implementation.

Project Coordinator

Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Executive Director, Apoti Development Association

Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

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